CHRITAIAN STORYTELLING
(OUTREACH MINISTRY)

Definitions:

1) **Christian** – n. A person who is a believer in Christianity
2) **Christianity** – n. The religion based on the Person and teachings of Christ
3) **Storytelling** – v. The art of telling stories
4) **Storyteller** – n. A person who tells stories.
5) **Story** – n. An account of imaginary or real people, experiences and events etc.
6) **Parable** - n. A simple story used to illustrate A moral or spiritual lesson

- A **story requires** a **place**, **date** and **time** while a **parable does not requires** a **place**, **date** or **time**.

Sources of Christian Stories

a) Scared history (Bible) **b)** Church History
c) Nature **d)** Books, Magazines & Newspaper
e) Life Experience (Character Stories) **f)** Web

Purpose of Telling Stories

a) Educate b) Warn c) Inform
d) Entertain e) Persuade f) Encourage

Characteristic of a Good Storyteller

- Must be active to attract the attention of the listeners
- Must be creative
- Must be resourceful in order to make the listeners understand
- Must enjoy telling stories
- Ensure eye contacts
- Must be of good character
- Must be neatly dressed
- Must be fluent in speech – attracts the confidence of the listeners.

Essentials of Storytelling

- **Know your story** – Ponder over it so that it becomes your own.
- **See your story**
- **Adapt your story** – Modify your story to suit the audience.
- **Tell your story** – Do not read out the story.
- **Live your story** – Make each character in the story real living people.
- **Feel the story** – Make the story part of you.
- **Have a climax (**the end**)** – When you reach the climax, STOP. The climax only settles the matter at hand and does not leave everyone living happily ever after.

Hare, Eric B. *Christian Storytelling Notes*

NOTE: Select your story keeping in mind the target audience. Choose a story that you feel confident and comfortable to tell.

Analyse and outline your story – Plan each of the scenes, take each of the characters and work out who is who in the story and what the problem is.

- *A story well-prepared is 90% given* (**Pr. John Wells**)

Parts of a story (Outline)

1. **Setup** – Where and When
   – Description of the **Main Character**
2. **Conflict** – Description of the **Opposition**
   – Nature of the conflict
3. **Reaction to Conflict** – What the opposition does
   – What the Main Character does
4. **Resolution** – How the conflict is Resolved
5. **Aftermath** – What happens to the opposition
   – Lesson learned

- Story requires a person, hero or heroine, or animal with a problem to be solved (Accomplishment story; Decision story; Theme story).
- The story needs conflict (creates interest in the story)

A Different View:

1. **Title and Theme** – Introduces the story
2. **Introduction** – Spell out the story (Background)
3. **Main Body** – Develops into a story
4. **Climax** – Emphases on the main points

5. **Conclusion** – Presents the appeal in a story.

Modifying a Story

Reasons for modifying a Story:

- ✓ Kind of audience group
- ✓ To suit attention span of your audience
- ✓ To achieve intended purpose
- ✓ Meet the amount of time allotted to tell the story
- ✓ To suit location of storytelling (e.g. space, resources available)

Making a Story Shorter:

- ➢ Skip over unnecessary details (e.g. description of the clothes worn)
- ➢ Eliminate sub-plots
- ➢ Withhold background information
- ➢ Any combination of the above.

Making Story Longer:

- ➢ Add extra details (e.g. mode of travel)
- ➢ Add side-stories
- ➢ Include background information
- ➢ Any combination of the above.

Stories told in 1st Person:

- ➢ A story told where the words **"I", "me", "we", "and "us"** are used.
- ➢ Story about yourself.
- ➢ Among the most compelling – comes from storyteller's experience.

Stories told in 2nd Person:

- ➢ Story told where the word **"you"** is used.
- ➢ Best told by directing your audience to close their eyes and imagining specific points in the story (engages their imagination)
- ➢ Puts the audience right in the story.
- ➢ Helps the audience better relate to the people in the story and the lesson it conveys.

Stories told in 3rd Person:

- ➢ Story told about someone else.
- ➢ The downside – audience assumes you have no personal experience in the matter, and they are not fully engaged.
- ❖ If you are telling a story about someone the audience knows (or knows about), it may be important to leave it in the third person.

Having a Definite aim in Storytelling

- ➢ A story without an aim is **idle** entertainment.
- ✓ A story with an aim can teach a lesson or get a message across or educate.
- ❖ A life lesson or moral to the story is not always needed to have an aim.
- ❖ The aim may be different but at the end the audience should be able to say how they have learnt from the story without having to be told or you would have wasted your time and theirs.

Types of Stories

1. **Myths:** Narratives that through many retelling has become an acceptable tradition in society (**Greek gods like Zeus, Hades)**
2. **Fairy Tales:** Stories for children with imaginary characters or magical people (e.g. **Barbie**, **Snow White**)
3. **Legends:** Stories were the subject is a heroic figure or legend. Portrays a human being rather than a god (e.g. **David & Goliath**)
4. **Fables:** Short stories, fictitious, typically with animals as characters, conveying a universal caution or moral (e.g. **Animal Farm**) *1 Tim 1:3, 4; Titus 1:14*
5. **Allegory:** Figurative narratives or artistic expression conveying a symbolic meaning parallel to but distinct from and more important than the literal meaning – extended metaphor (e.g. The **prodigal Son**)

"Teacher, remember that the Lord is your strength. Strive to give the students ideas that will be to them a saviour of life unto life. Teach by illustrations. Ask God to give you words to speak that all will understand." *Ellen G. White – Counsel to Teachers p 254.*